

DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS

**Justification for Single Source Awards IAW [FAR 13.106-1](#)
For
Over Micro-Purchase Threshold but Not Exceeding the SAT (\$250K)**

Acquisition Plan Action ID: VA-25-00052989

- 1. Contracting Activity:** Department of Veterans Affairs, VISN 16, Michael E. DeBakey VA Medical Center, 2002 Holcombe Blvd., Houston, TX 77030, Clinical Practice Office (CPO/118).
- 2. Brief Description of Supplies/ Services required and the intended use/Estimated Amount:** The Michael E. DeBakey VA Medical Center seeks to prepare newly hired nurses for the Critical Care Units with an evidence-based orientation program that will prepare them to competently provide quality care to our veterans. Chief objectives are to develop a competent Critical Care Workforce; increase quality and safety in work performance, and increase satisfaction and retention of nurses. This requirement will be offered as a Firm-Fixed Price contract, with an estimated total amount of \$7,335.00.
- 3. Unique characteristics that limit availability to only one source, with the reason no other supplies or services can be used:**

The Michael E. DeBakey VA Medical Center must continue to prepare newly hired nurses of the Critical Care Units with an evidence-based orientation program that will prepare them to competently provide quality care to veterans. The objectives of this training are the continuation of competent Critical Care workforce development, increased quality and safety in work performance, and increased satisfaction and retention of nurses. The current contractor, the American Association of Critical-Care Nurses (AACN), has been used for numerous years with excellent outcomes. The requested training provides consistency with knowledge, content, and methodology that provides quality patient care to MEDVAMC Veterans. For this reason, and because standardization and uniformity for this product have been established, healthcare professionals are familiar with training procedures for this brand. Therefore, this will eliminate the need to re-train, minimize staff errors and patient care will be improved. No other training program was found that was a commercial, off the shelf product and ready to use with prior success such as ECCO. VA nursing staff have the ability to modify the program for alignment with VA, VISN, and VA specific objectives if necessary.
- 4. Description of market research conducted and results or statement why it was not conducted:**

VHA strategic contracts and AbilityOne searched, but the required products not available. NOI posted with this Justification. Market research conducted and found that AACN owns all proprietary rights to the Essentials of Critical Care Orientation (ECCO) course. Alternative courses investigated either were not found suitable for the station needs. As a result recommending moving forward as a sole source to the American Association of Critical Care Nurses to meet the VA standards.
- 5. Contracting Officer's Certification:** *Purchase is approved in accordance with FAR13.106-1(b). I certify that the foregoing justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.*

VHAPG Part 813.106 Simplified Acquisition Procedures: Soliciting from a Single Source
Attachment 1: Single Source Justification for SAP under the SAT

Name
Title

Date